3. According to the passage, why should the discharge of agricultural slurry into watercourses be restricted ?

1. Losing nutrients in this way is not a good practice economically
2. Watercourses do not contain the microorganisms that can decompose organic components of agricultural slurry.
3. The discharge may lead to the eutrophication of water bodies.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below :

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1,2 and 3

Ans. (c) : According to the passage the discharge agricultural slurry into watercourses should be restricted because the discharge may lead to the eutrophication of water bodies and losing nutrients in this way is not a good practice economically and thus only statement (1) and (3) are corrected.

4. The passage refers to the conversion of ''pollutant to fertilizer''. What is pollutant and what is fertilizer in this context ?

(a) Decomposed organic component of slurry is pollutant and microorganisms in soil constituent fertilizer.
(b) Discharged agricultural slurry is pollutant and decomposed slurry in soil is fertilizer.
(c) Sprayed slurry is pollutant and watercourse is fertilizer.
(d) None of the above expressions is correct in this context.

Ans. (b) : According to the passage, "Discharged agricultural slurry is pollutant and decomposed slurry in soil is fertilizer. Soil microorganisms decompose the organic components of sewage and slurry and most of mineral nutrients become available to be absorbed again by the vegetation."

5. According to the passage, what are the effects of indiscriminate use of fertilizers ?

1. Addition of pollutants to the soil and water
2. Destruction of decomposer microorganisms in soil.
3. Nutrient enrichment of water bodies.
4. Creation of algal blooms.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below-

(a) 1, 2 and 3 only
(b) 1, 3 and 4
(c) 2 and 4
(d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (b) : According to the passage, the indiscriminate use of fertilizer can cause addition of pollutants to the soil and water, nutrients enrichments of water bodies and thus creation of algal blooms. The excess input of nutrients both nitrogen and phosphorus-based from agricultural runoff has caused many healthy lakes to high phytoplankton. This makes the water turbid eliminates large plants and in worst situation leads to anoxia and fish kill and thus disturbs aquatic ecosystem.

6. What is /are the characteristics of a water body with cultural eutrophication ?

1. Loss of ecosystem service
2. Loss of flora and fauna
3. Loss of mineral nutrients

Select the correct answer from the codes given below :

(a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (b) : In cultural eutrophication, important ecosystem service are lost, including the provisioning service of wild-caught fish and the cultural services associated with recreation and thus it results in loss of flora and fauna and loss of ecosystem service and thus, only statement (1) and (2) are correct.

7. What is the central theme of this passage ?

(a) Appropriate legislation is essential to protect the environment.
(b) Modern agriculture is responsible for the destruction of environment.
(c) Improper waste disposal from agriculture can destroy the aquatic ecosystems.
(d) Use of chemical fertilizers is undesirable in agriculture.

Ans. (c) : The central theme of the passage is to maintain cleanliness of water and to balance aquatic ecosystem by using proper fertilizers and thus improper waste disposal from agriculture can destroy the aquatic ecosystems.

Passage-2

The miseries of the world cannot be cured by physical help only. Until man's nature changes, his physical needs will always arise, and miseries will always be felt, and no amount of physical help will remove them completely. The only solution of the problem is to make making pure. Ignorance is the mother of evil and of all the misery we see. Let men have light, let them be pure and spiritually strong and educated; them alone will misery cease in the world . We may convert every house in the country into a charitable asylum, but human misery will continue until man's character changes.

8. According to the passage, which of the following statements is most likely to be true as the reason for man's miseries ?

(a) The poor economic and social conditions prevailing in society
(b) The refusal on the part of man to change his character.
(c) The absence of physical and material help from his society
(d) Ever increasing physical needs due to changing social structure.

Ans. (b) : According to the passage, the miseries of the world cannot be cured by physical help only untils man nature changes, his physical needs will always arise and miseries will always be felt. Thus option (b) is correct.

9. With reference to the passage, the following assumptions have been made :

1. The author gives primary importance to physical and material help in eradicating human misery.
2. Charitable homes, hospitals, etc. can remove human misery to a great extent.

Which of the assumptions is/are valid ?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (d) : According to the passage, the author gives primary importance to man's character while eradicating human misery thus, statement (1) is not correct. Only Humans character can remove human misery to greater extent. Charitable homes, hospitals etc can not remove human misery. Thus both the assumptions made are wrong.

Directions for the following 8 (eight) items :

Read the following four passages and answer the items that follow each passage. Your answers to these items should be based on the passages only.

Passage-1

The subject of democracy has become severely muddled because of the way the rhetoric surrounding it has been used in recent years. There is, increasingly, an oddly confused dichotomy between those who want to 'impose' democracy on countries in the non-Western world (in these countries' 'own interest', of course) and those who are opposed to such 'imposition' (because of the respect for the countries', own ways'). But the entire language of 'imposition', used by both sides, is extraordinarily inappropriate since it makes in implicit assumption that democracy belongs exclusively to the West, taking it to be quintessentially' Western' idea which has originated and flourished only in the West.

But the thesis and the pessimism it generates about the possibility of democratic practice in the world would be extremely hard to justify. There were several experiments in local democracy in ancient India. Indeed, in understanding the roots of democracy in the world, we have to take an interest in the history of people-participation and pubic reasoning in different parts of the world. We have to look beyond thinking of democracy only in terms of European and American evolution . We would fail to understand the pervasive demands for participatory living, on which Aristotle spoke with far-reaching insight, if we take democracy to be a kind of a specialized cultural product of the West.

It cannot, of course be doubted that the institutional structure of the contemporary practice of democracy is largely the product of European and American experience over the last few countries. This is extremely important to recognize since these developments in institutional formats were immensely innovative and ultimately effective. There can be little doubt that there is a major 'Western' achievement here.

10. Which of the following is closest to the view of democracy as mentioned in the above passage ?

(a) The subject of democracy is a muddle due to a desire to portray it as a Western concept, 'alien' to non-Western countries.
(b) The language of imposition of democracy is inappropriate. There is, however, a need to consider this concept in the backdrop of culture of 'own ways' of non-Western society.
(c) While democracy is not essentially a Western idea belonging exclusively to the West, the institutional structure of current democratic practices has been their contribution.
(d) None of the statements (a), (b) and (c) given above is correct

Ans. (c) : According to the passage, while democracy is not essentially a western idea belonging exclusively to the West. The institutional structure of current democratic practices has been their contribution. It cannot, of course be doubted that the institutional structure of the contemporary practice of democracy is largely the product of European and American experience over the last few countries.

11. With reference to the passage, the following assumption have been made :

1. Many of the non-Western countries are unable to have democracy because they take democracy to be a specialized cultural product of the West.
2. Western countries are always trying, to impose democracy on non-Western countries.

Which of the above is/are valid assumption/ assumptions ?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2